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Interview available upon request

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20,000 SIGN CHANGE.ORG PETITION TO REINSTATE HOLY ROSARY PRINCIPAL DARREN MULLIS

Families protested Aug. 21 after departure letter offered no public explanation; Mullis has not spoken publicly

MEMPHIS, Tenn. — A Change.org petition calling for the reinstatement of Darren Mullis as principal of Holy Rosary Catholic School in East Memphis surpassed 20,000 signatures on August 25, 2026 — five days after it launched — according to organizers with Rams Fight Back, an independent community campaign.

Mullis has led Holy Rosary as principal since 2003. A lifelong Ram — student through eighth grade and a graduate of Christian Brothers High School — he returned to the parish school as a teacher and administrator before his appointment as principal. His family has been part of the Holy Rosary parish and school community for decades.

On August 19, families received a letter stating Mullis “will be departing from Holy Rosary School as our principal” and wishing him well, without a public explanation for the decision. Parents shared the letter on social media. Local news outlets, including the Commercial Appeal, reported that the letter did not use the word “dismissal,” though many families have described the move that way.

Two days later, on August 21, families gathered outside the Catholic Diocese of Memphis to protest the abrupt exit. WREG and other local outlets covered the demonstration. Holy Rosary Parish and Catholic Schools of Memphis issued a joint statement calling Mullis’s departure a “confidential personnel matter that we are not able to discuss.” Rhiannon Thomas, a first-grade teacher at Holy Rosary, was named interim principal for the remainder of the school year. Mullis has not issued a public statement.

The Change.org petition, “Reinstate Darren Mullis as principal at Holy Rosary Catholic School,” was launched August 22 by Ryan Taylor, a Holy Rosary alum who helped form Rams Fight Back with a small group of organizers, the day after the diocese protest. Signers include parents, alumni, teachers, and parishioners from Memphis and beyond.

“Twenty thousand names is not a fringe reaction,” said an anonymous Ram alum organizing with Rams Fight Back, who asked not to be named. “These are people who know this school — families who trusted Darren Mullis with their children, alumni who came back because of what he built, and parishioners who watched him serve this community for more than two decades. They are asking for honesty and for their principal back.”

Rams Fight Back operates independently of Holy Rosary Catholic School, Holy Rosary Parish, and the Catholic Diocese of Memphis. The campaign site — holyrosaryfightsbactn.com — provides petition tools, printable materials, and contact information for decision makers, including parish and diocesan leadership.

The petition remains open at c.org/2LMccZY9dk. Organizers said reaching 20,000 signatures triggers outreach to everyone on the campaign’s mobilization list to plan a community gathering within 30 days.



WE ARE Rams!

RAMS FIGHT BACK

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ABOUT RAMS FIGHT BACK

Community-led campaign supporting the reinstatement of Darren Mullis as principal of Holy Rosary Catholic School in Memphis. Run and paid for by a small group of Holy Rosary alumni and supporters. Not affiliated with Holy Rosary Catholic School, Holy Rosary Parish, or the Catholic Diocese of Memphis.